

Duskmourn Report: Learned Archetypes, Bombs, and Synergies

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Dataset Snapshot

This run uses 216,329 unique deck builds and 1,011,949 game rows. The unsupervised clustering stage produced 11 learned archetypes. The best-performing large shells are Boros Toy | Ragged Playmate / Vicious Clown, Azorius Humans | Tunnel Surveyor / Gremlin Tamer, Gruul | Wildfire Wickerfolk / Beastie Beatdown, which already tells us that the format is not a single monolithic color table: it separates into distinct deck families with their own signposts, core cards, and build-around incentives.

1 Discovered Archetypes

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Boros Toy Ragged Playmate / Vicious Clown	29,232	144,562	56.85%	Ragged Playmate, Vicious Clown, Midnight Mayhem, Arabella, Abandoned Doll, Turn Inside Out
Azorius Humans Tunnel Surveyor / Gremlin Tamer	33,023	160,780	56.22%	Tunnel Surveyor, Gremlin Tamer, Glimmerburst, Grand Entryway // Elegant Rotunda, Inquisitive Glimmer
Gruul Wildfire Wickerfolk / Beastie Beatdown	20,771	100,770	55.41%	Wildfire Wickerfolk, Beastie Beatdown, Hand That Feeds, Most Valuable Slayer, Turn Inside Out
Simic Humans Oblivious Bookworm / Growing Dread	28,470	133,292	55.24%	Oblivious Bookworm, Growing Dread, Cryptid Inspector, Manifest Dread, Paranormal Analyst
Rakdos Disturbing Mirth / Final Vengeance	19,408	89,764	54.62%	Disturbing Mirth, Final Vengeance, Sawblade Skinripper, Innocuous Rat, Fear of Lost Teeth
Golgari Broodspinner / Drag to the Roots	19,799	91,663	53.95%	Broodspinner, Drag to the Roots, Murder, Say Its Name, Spineseeker Centipede

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Gruul Spineseeker Centipede / Moldering Gym // Weight Room	11,341	50,885	53.24%	Spineseeker Centipede, Moldering Gym // Weight Room, Say Its Name, Wary Watchdog, Beastie Beatdown
Selesnya Humans Shrewd Storyteller / Baseball Bat	11,961	55,655	52.15%	Shrewd Storyteller, Baseball Bat, Acrobatic Cheerleader, Hardened Escort, Friendly Ghost
Orzhov Emerge from the Cocoon / Shroud-stomper	15,210	66,701	51.48%	Emerge from the Cocoon, Shroudstomper, Rite of the Moth, Fanatic of the Harrowing, Spectral Snatcher
Izzet Spirit Smoky Lounge // Misty Salon / Rampaging Soulrager	14,343	63,272	51.29%	Smoky Lounge // Misty Salon, Rampaging Soulrager, Intruding Soulrager, Glassworks // Shattered Yard, Meat Locker // Drowned Diner
Dimir Fear of Infinity / Skullsnap Nuisance	12,771	54,605	51.07%	Fear of Infinity, Skullsnap Nuisance, Balemurk Leech, Unable to Scream, Meat Locker // Drowned Diner

2 What Defines the Best Shells

Boros Toy | Ragged Playmate / Vicious Clown

This cluster contains 29,232 decks across 144,562 games and posts a baseline win rate of 56.85%. Its defining cards are **Ragged Playmate**, **Vicious Clown**, **Midnight Mayhem**, **Arabella**, **Abandoned Doll**, **Turn Inside Out**, **Clockwork Percussionist**.

The strongest positive links in the shell are **Midnight Mayhem + Painter's Studio // Defaced Gallery**. The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

Azorius Humans | Tunnel Surveyor / Gremlin Tamer

This cluster contains 33,023 decks across 160,780 games and posts a baseline win rate of 56.22%. Its defining cards are **Tunnel Surveyor**, **Gremlin Tamer**, **Glimmerburst**, **Grand Entryway // Elegant Rotunda**, **Inquisitive Glimmer**, **Unable to Scream**.

The strongest positive links in the shell are **Erratic Apparition + Fear of Surveillance**. The build-around detector flags **Erratic Apparition**, **Fear of Surveillance** as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

Gruul | Wildfire Wickerfolk / Beastie Beatdown

This cluster contains 20,771 decks across 100,770 games and posts a baseline win rate of 55.41%. Its defining cards are **Wildfire Wickerfolk**, **Beastie Beatdown**, **Hand That Feeds**, **Most Valuable Slayer**, **Turn Inside Out**, **Scorching Dragonfire**.

The strongest positive links in the shell are . The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

Simic Humans | Oblivious Bookworm / Growing Dread

This cluster contains 28,470 decks across 133,292 games and posts a baseline win rate of 55.24%. Its defining cards are **Oblivious Bookworm**, **Growing Dread**, **Cryptid Inspector**, **Manifest Dread**, **Paranormal Analyst**, **Bashful Beastie**.

The strongest positive links in the shell are . The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

3 Bombs: Cards That Are Good Alone

Card	Best cluster	Standalone lift	Drawn-game WR	Games
Valgavoth's Onslaught	Gruul Spineseeker Centipede / Moldering Gym // Weight Room	17.88 pp	71.12%	1593
Unholy Annex // Ritual Chamber	Dimir Fear of Infinity / Skullsnap Nuisance	14.87 pp	65.94%	2381
Overlord of the Mistmoors	Azorius Humans Tunnel Surveyor / Gremlin Tamer	14.18 pp	70.40%	2132
The Roller crusher Ride	Gruul Spineseeker Centipede / Moldering Gym // Weight Room	13.80 pp	67.04%	710
Overlord of the Boilerbilges	Gruul Wildfire Wickerfolk / Beastie Beatdown	12.90 pp	68.31%	1297
The Swarmweaver	Gruul Spineseeker Centipede / Moldering Gym // Weight Room	12.54 pp	65.78%	1958
Ghostly Dancers	Azorius Humans Tunnel Surveyor / Gremlin Tamer	12.00 pp	68.22%	6287
Tyvar, the Pummeler	Selesnya Humans Shrewd Storyteller / Baseball Bat	9.94 pp	62.09%	881

Card	Best cluster	Standalone lift	Drawn-game WR	Games
Floodpits Drowner	Izzet Spirit Smoky Lounge // Misty Salon / Rampaging Soulrager	9.78 pp	61.07%	5600
Sheltered by Ghosts	Selesnya Humans Shrewd Storyteller / Baseball Bat	9.64 pp	61.80%	3264
Fear of Isolation	Izzet Spirit Smoky Lounge // Misty Salon / Rampaging Soulrager	9.60 pp	60.89%	5669
Unnerving Grasp	Izzet Spirit Smoky Lounge // Misty Salon / Rampaging Soulrager	9.55 pp	60.84%	5511

4 Build-Arounds and Shell Dependence

Card	Best cluster	Shell dependence	Support delta	Supported games
Erratic Apparition	Azorius Humans Tunnel Surveyor / Gremlin Tamer	10.0 / 10	11.84 pp	14786
Fear of Surveillance	Azorius Humans Tunnel Surveyor / Gremlin Tamer	9.9 / 10	6.44 pp	23486

5 Dependency Cards

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Emerge from the Cocoon	Orzhov EmERGE from the Cocoon / Shroud-stomper	1.627	5.26 pp	12958
Spectral Snatcher	Orzhov EmERGE from the Cocoon / Shroud-stomper	1.179	3.26 pp	10258
Rite of the Moth	Orzhov EmERGE from the Cocoon / Shroud-stomper	0.875	5.70 pp	10439
Shroudstomper	Orzhov EmERGE from the Cocoon / Shroud-stomper	0.748	5.34 pp	11052

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Midnight Mayhem	Boros Toy Ragged Playmate / Vicious Clown	0.323	6.37 pp	19845
Painter's Studio // Defaced Gallery	Boros Toy Ragged Playmate / Vicious Clown	0.323	3.62 pp	10263
Live or Die	Orzhov Emerge from the Cocoon / Shroud- stomper	0.210	6.23 pp	6726
Trapped in the Screen	Orzhov Emerge from the Cocoon / Shroud- stomper	0.164	7.01 pp	9278
Fanatic of the Harrowing	Orzhov Emerge from the Cocoon / Shroud- stomper	0.158	5.14 pp	10181
Fear of Surveillance	Azorius Humans Tun- nel Surveyor / Gremlin Tamer	0.138	0.10 pp	24980
Erratic Apparition	Azorius Humans Tun- nel Surveyor / Gremlin Tamer	0.138	-0.76 pp	15720
Clockwork Percussionist	Boros Toy Ragged Playmate / Vicious Clown	0.000	-1.08 pp	24889

6 Best Draft Priorities

Card	Best cluster	Pick score	Draft win lift	Rarity
Disturbing Mirth	Rakdos Disturbing Mirth / Final Vengeance	10.0 / 10	1.15 pp	uncommon
The Swarmweaver	Golgari Broodspinner / Drag to the Roots	10.0 / 10	3.92 pp	rare
Midnight Mayhem	Boros Toy Ragged Playmate / Vicious Clown	10.0 / 10	1.21 pp	uncommon
Broodspinner	Golgari Broodspinner / Drag to the Roots	10.0 / 10	1.79 pp	uncommon
Ghostly Dancers	Azorius Humans Tun- nel Surveyor / Gremlin Tamer	10.0 / 10	3.40 pp	rare
Roaring Furnace // Steaming Sauna	Izzet Spirit Smoky Lounge // Misty Salon / Rampaging Soulrager	10.0 / 10	2.12 pp	rare

Card	Best cluster	Pick score	Draft win lift	Rarity
Valgavoth's Onslaught	Gruul Spineseeker Centipede / Moldering Gym // Weight Room	10.0 / 10	5.23 pp	rare
Unnerving Grasp	Simic Humans Oblivious Bookworm / Growing Dread	10.0 / 10	2.14 pp	uncommon
Rite of the Moth	Orzhov Emerge from the Cocoon / Shroudstomper	10.0 / 10	0.79 pp	uncommon
Shroudstomper	Orzhov Emerge from the Cocoon / Shroudstomper	10.0 / 10	0.74 pp	uncommon
Fear of Isolation	Azorius Humans Tunnel Surveyor / Gremlin Tamer	10.0 / 10	1.97 pp	uncommon
Sheltered by Ghosts	Azorius Humans Tunnel Surveyor / Gremlin Tamer	10.0 / 10	1.78 pp	uncommon

7 Most Striking Positive Pairs

Pair	Cluster	Quality	Pair WR	Games
Midnight Mayhem, Painter's Studio // Defaced Gallery	Boros Toy Ragged Playmate / Vicious Clown	3.12	73.38%	1371
Emerge from the Cocoon, Shroudstomper	Orzhov Emerge from the Cocoon / Shroudstomper	1.94	64.98%	2773
Shroudstomper, Spectral Snatcher	Orzhov Emerge from the Cocoon / Shroudstomper	1.87	64.19%	1832
Live or Die, Shroudstomper	Orzhov Emerge from the Cocoon / Shroudstomper	1.85	67.62%	1229
Fanatic of the Harrowing, Shroudstomper	Orzhov Emerge from the Cocoon / Shroudstomper	1.69	65.48%	2219
Rite of the Moth, Shroudstomper	Orzhov Emerge from the Cocoon / Shroudstomper	1.67	65.68%	1996
Shroudstomper, Trapped in the Screen	Orzhov Emerge from the Cocoon / Shroudstomper	1.66	67.31%	1664
Erratic Apparition, Fear of Surveillance	Azorius Humans Tunnel Surveyor / Gremlin Tamer	0.47	58.94%	2516

8 Anti-Synergies Worth Respecting

Pair	Cluster	Anti-score	Pair WR	Games
Acrobatic Cheerleader, Shrewd Storyteller	Selesnya Humans Shrewd Storyteller / Baseball Bat	0.66	43.40%	887
Frantic Strength, Veteran Survivor	Selesnya Humans Shrewd Storyteller / Baseball Bat	0.59	43.78%	185
Acrobatic Cheerleader, Norin, Swift Survivalist	Boros Toy Ragged Play- mate / Vicious Clown	0.48	47.69%	996
Horrid Vigor, Veteran Survivor	Selesnya Humans Shrewd Storyteller / Baseball Bat	0.45	44.25%	226
Monstrous Emergence, Orphans of the Wheat	Selesnya Humans Shrewd Storyteller / Baseball Bat	0.44	45.30%	415
Acrobatic Cheerleader, Horrid Vigor	Selesnya Humans Shrewd Storyteller / Baseball Bat	0.41	45.47%	530
Acrobatic Cheerleader, Clockwork Percussionist	Boros Toy Ragged Play- mate / Vicious Clown	0.36	50.69%	2383
Balemurk Leech, Shepherding Spirits	Orzhov Emerge from the Cocoon / Shroudstopper	0.30	47.81%	548
Fear of Surveillance, Veteran Survivor	Selesnya Humans Shrewd Storyteller / Baseball Bat	0.28	45.38%	379
Savior of the Small, Shrewd Storyteller	Selesnya Humans Shrewd Storyteller / Baseball Bat	0.27	45.89%	401

9 Bottom-Line Reading

This report treats the format as a deck ecosystem rather than a flat card ranking. The strongest cards show up in the bomb table because they win on their own. The cards that pull a cluster together show up in the build-around and dependency tables because they need a shell. The pair and anti-synergy sections then explain which combinations reinforce a winning plan and which combinations look attractive in draft but underperform together.